Thus, acids are defined as the chemical substances which release hydrogen ions when dissolved in water.

Acids can be classified into organic acids and inorganic acids depending on the sources. Some acids occur naturally in fruits and vegetables. These are called organic acids. Examples: Citric acid, tartaric acid etc.,

Table 14.1 Organic acids and their sources

Name of the Acid	Source
Citric acid	Lemon
Lactic acid	Sour milk
Oxalic acid	Tomato
Acetic acid	Vinegar
Malic acid	Apple
Tartaric acid	Tamarind

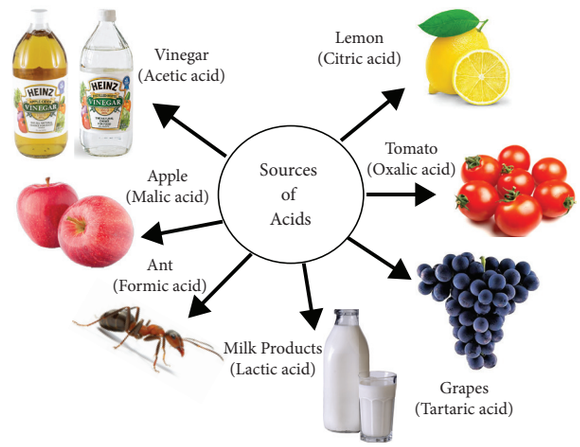


Figure 14.1 Acids and their sources

On the other hand, acids are produced artificially in industries. These acids are called mineral acids or inorganic acids. Examples: Hydrochloric acid (HCl), Sulphuric acid (H_2SO_4), Nitric acid (HNO_3) etc., There are many more classifications of acids. You will study about them in your higher classes.

14.1.1 Properties of Acids

a. Physical properties

- Acids are sour in taste.
- They are corrosive in nature. Strong acids can spoil substances like human skin, clothes and paper.
- Generally acids exist in liquid state but few acids exist in solid state as well. E.g. Benzoic acid
- Acids are colourless.
- Acids change the colour of the indicators. Blue litmus paper turns red and methyl orange turns pink when treated with acids.
- They are soluble in water.
- Solutions of acids conduct electricity due to ionisation in water.



Figure 14.2 Benzoic acid crystals

DO YOU KNOW?

We feel hungry due to the corrosive action of hydrochloric acid on the inner lining of the stomach. When the level of hydrochloric acid goes higher, it causes ulcer.

b. Chemical properties

i. Reaction with metals

Metals like zinc, magnesium, aluminum, iron etc., react with acids like hydrochloric acid, sulphuric acid to form metal salts and release hydrogen gas.

Metal + Dilute acids → Metal salt + Hydrogen

Examples

Zinc + Hydrochloric acid → Zinc chloride + Hydrogen

$$Zn + 2HCl \rightarrow ZnCl_2 + H_2\uparrow$$

Iron + Sulphuric acid → Ferrous sulphate + Hydrogen

$$Fe + H_2SO_4 \rightarrow FeSO_4 + H_2\uparrow$$

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